



Sir Vivian Richards, featuring a picture of the former batting star. This commemorative currency (right) was launched in Antigua, Richards' birthplace, during a ceremony marking the 40th anniversary of the Eastern Caribbean Central Bank.

The Diary was chuffed to bits as he took off for Trinidad for the first semifinal between South Africa and Afghanistan.

Rashid Khan's men were no match for the ruthless Protean pacers as Aiden Markram and his team made history by qualifying for their first-ever World Cup final.

The trip back to Barbados for the final wasn't smooth. Flight connectivity in the Caribbean is often problematic, and the limited fleet of aircraft on each island struggled to handle the strain of a major tournament like the T20 World Cup.

The Diary learned this the hard way when what should have been a one-hour trip from Trinidad to Barbados turned into an all-day

Bon appétit: Spice of India offered some delectable *naans* and a decent butter chicken curry. PICS: AYAN ACHARYA

ordeal. However, the breathtaking views of the airports in transit helped ease the frustration to some extent.

At the Kensington Oval in Bridgetown, Barbados, under overcast skies, Rohit's men clinched their second T20 World Cup title, defeating South Africa by seven runs in a nail-biting final. Celebrations erupted in the dressing room, even as a hurricane warning loomed large.

Hurricane Beryl, a formidable Category 4 storm, was expected to pass by Barbados on Sunday night, with its centre projected to be approximately 80 miles off the south coast.

As the Indian team found itself stranded, the Diary chose to get out ahead of the storm instead of waiting for it to pass and risk getting stuck with a possible airport shutdown.

